

T. Scott Stroup, MD, MPH
Professor of Psychiatry

Vice Chair for Academic Affairs
Department of Psychiatry



COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY

*College of Physicians
and Surgeons*

New York State Psychiatric Institute
1051 Riverside Drive, Unit 100
New York, NY 10032
646.774.8435 Tel
Scott.Stroup@nyspi.columbia.edu

October 7, 2025

Jiook Cha, PhD

Professor of Psychology at Seoul National University (SNU), South Korea

Building 16, Room M512, Department of Psychology, SNU, South Korea

Phone#: +82-2-880-8618

Email address: connectome@snu.ac.kr

Dear Dr. Cha,

The Department of Psychiatry at the Vagelos College of Physicians and Surgeons of Columbia University is considering an appointment of **Xiaofu He, PhD** to the rank of **Associate Professor of Clinical Neurobiology (in Psychiatry)**. Dr. He's principal contributions have been on the **Investigator Area of Focus**. We would like to obtain your candid and confidential opinion concerning the advisability of recommending Dr. He to this appointment at this time.

The rank of **Associate Professor of Clinical Neurobiology (in Psychiatry)** is not a tenure-track position. Although most faculty will have a major academic focus, as described below, with accompanying evidence of competency in educational activity, there may be instances in which faculty make high quality, substantive contributions in more than one area of focus. Faculty may also have contributions that are less quantitatively or more narrowly concentrated in the other areas of focus. However, it is the sum total of major and minor achievements that determines a faculty members suitability for appointment or promotion in rank. Because faculty often make contributions in multiple academic areas of focus, your comments need only address the area(s) of focus of the candidate with which you are familiar.

Promotion to Associate Professor should be marked by a strong regional reputation and an emerging national reputation in the area of focus. Faculty at this level should be acknowledged by peers inside and outside of CUIMC as experts in their area of focus.

Promotion to Professor should be marked by national recognition of contributions within the area of focus. Faculty at this rank should be widely acknowledged by peers inside and outside of CUIMC as exceptional within their area of focus.

Within the title, there are three areas of scholarly focus briefly defined below that faculty may choose as major or minor areas of academic focus:

Investigator Area of Focus

Evidence for concentration in the Investigator area of focus may be demonstrated by: quality and quantity of publications in peer-reviewed journals, authorship on multi-authored publications and/or documentation of a substantial contribution by the candidate to collaborative, multidisciplinary investigations and publications. The faculty member may be a principal

investigator or a significant collaborator on funded research grants or contracts originating from federal, foundation or industry sources. Further evidence could be demonstrated by invited lectures that highlight recognition of investigation expertise or by service on editorial boards, expert panels, FDA panels, and data safety monitoring boards for multicenter studies.

Applied Health Care or Public Health Interventions Area of Focus

Evidence for concentration in the Applied Healthcare or Public Health Sciences area of focus can be demonstrated through recognition as an expert clinician or public health professional, honors and leadership in regional or national professional societies of the clinical or public health discipline; important contributions to institutional or national quality assurance programs; development of or leading the application of clinical or public health technology that changes practice or patient outcomes; membership on editorial boards of clinical or public health specialty journals; authorship of book chapters and case reports; participation in clinical or public health research as a site investigator for large multi-center trials or public health intervention programs within the discipline; or development of guidelines or patient care or public health protocols which are used locally, regionally or nationally.

Educational Leadership and Scholarship Area of Focus

Evidence for concentration in the Educational Leadership/Scholarship area of focus may be demonstrated by a robust and varied portfolio of educational activities: development of educational materials, including new curricula offerings, educational programs, textbook chapters, syllabi, computer programs, videotapes or simulation technology that make a unique contribution to the quality and methods of education in academic settings and/or community(ies); regional or national recognition of educational expertise demonstrated by participation and/or leadership in educational societies, invited lectureships and publications related to education; exceptional and high-quality contributions to the teaching of students, postgraduate students or professionals.

Quality and Patient Safety Area of Focus

Evidence for concentration in the Quality and Patient Safety area of focus may be demonstrated by involvement and impact of work in quality improvement and/or patient safety activities, teaching, and/or research; documented effectiveness of impact of work, including new workflows, improvement in systems or processes of care; enhanced decision support; improved patient outcomes; evidence of decreased medical errors; demonstration of service on local or national organization committees and/or by meaningful participation on departmental, university, hospital committees; education of patients and the community related to quality and/or patient safety are also considered in this category.

All faculty members are expected to participate in some educational activities, which may include: lectures, seminars, conferences, small group tutorials, grand rounds, hospital and outpatient preceptorial teaching, research mentorship, career advisory mentorship, student advising, morning report, didactic presentations, continuing professional education or community-based educational programs.

Please note that community-based scholarship in any of these four areas of focus, as well as faculty efforts to improve inclusion, well-being, engagement, and professionalism are explicitly included as potential areas of academic recognition for promotion.

Dr. He's curriculum vita is enclosed for your examination. To maintain the schedule of the review, it would be helpful to have your comments by no later than **November 17, 2025**. I assure you that your reply will be kept confidential to the extent permitted by law and that it will be reviewed only by the faculty members and administrators involved in the review process. Your letter of evaluation can be sent to me at the following address:

We recognize that this request adds significantly to your busy schedule and very much appreciate your contribution to the process. Please email your review as an attachment on your letterhead, signed (PDF preferred but Word document also acceptable with electronic signature). Please address it to me but email it to: is2727@cumc.columbia.edu.

If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to contact Ileana Sanchez at is2727@cumc.columbia.edu. If you would like to speak with me directly, I can be reached best via email at tss2119@cumc.columbia.edu.

If you plan to send your response via standard mail, please send it to this address:

Mailing address for hard copy: T. Scott Stroup, MD, MPH
Professor and Vice Chair, Academic Affairs
Department of Psychiatry
Columbia University Irving Medical Center
1051 Riverside Drive, Unit #100
New York, NY 10032

Thank you for your assistance in this important endeavor.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "T. Scott Stroup". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "T." and last name "Stroup" clearly legible.

T. Scott Stroup, MD, MPH
Professor and Vice Chair, Academic Affairs
Department of Psychiatry

Sent on behalf of Dr. Stroup by Ileana Sanchez (is2727@cumc.columbia.edu)